GUJARATI COLLECTION

NO. 01



SURAT ORIGIN

Undhiyu

Winter Mixed Vegetable Medley
with Spiced Fenugreek Dumplings

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

LICENSE & COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Undhiyu

Sold via: Gumroad
Publisher: DhanioDigital (dhaniodigital.gumroad.com)

PERSONAL USE LICENSE

This digital cookbook is licensed for personal, non-commercial use only.
You may print one (1) copy for your own kitchen use.

YOU MAY NOT:

- Share, resell, or redistribute this file in any form
- Upload to any website, cloud service, or file-sharing platform
- Remove or obscure any watermarks, copyright notices, or branding
- Use recipes for commercial food service without written permission

Violation of this license may result in legal action.

© 2024 DhanioDigital. All rights reserved.
Contact: support@dhaniodigital.com

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Undhiyu

AUTHOR

Sweta Verma

PUBLISHER

DhanioDigital

COPYRIGHT

© 2026 Sweta Verma. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced or distributed without written permission from the publisher.

DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Dish Cooked Upside Down

Undhiyu takes its name from the Gujarati word "undhu," meaning upside down, describing the dish's traditional cooking method: earthen pots packed with layers of winter vegetables were sealed, inverted, and buried in a pit dug into the ground, then cooked slowly over a wood fire lit above them. This ingenious technique, historically practiced by farmers around Surat, allowed the vegetables to steam gently in their own juices and each other's flavors, without direct contact with flame or excess water.

The dish is built specifically around Gujarat's winter harvest — purple yam, sweet potato, green beans, eggplant, and fresh tuvar lilva (pigeon peas, available only briefly each winter) — bound together with muthiya, small steamed dumplings made from fenugreek leaves and gram flour. This deliberate seasonality ties undhiyu closely to Uttarayan, the January kite-flying festival marking the winter solstice, when it's traditionally prepared and shared among family and neighbors.

While the underground pit method survives in some rural areas and at dedicated undhiyu specialty shops, most home cooks today recreate the dish's characteristic slow, gentle cooking using a heavy pot on the stovetop — a method this recipe follows, aiming to capture as much of that traditional depth of flavor as possible without requiring a backyard fire pit.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Dish Cooked Upside Down, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Traditionally cooked in earthen pots buried underground over a wood fire, a method still practiced in some rural areas and specialty shops around Surat. Closely tied to Uttarayan, Gujarat's January kite-flying festival marking the winter solstice. Built specifically around Gujarat's brief winter vegetable harvest, including fresh tuvar lilva available only for a few weeks each year. A dish traditionally shared among family and neighbors during the festive winter season, reflecting its communal, celebratory role.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

45m	1h	6	Hard
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Large, heavy-bottomed pot with a tight lid
- Steamer, for the muthiya
- Mixing bowls
- Small blender, for the green masala paste

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Undhiyu keeps refrigerated for up to 4 days and, like many slow-cooked vegetable dishes, tastes very good the next day. It freezes reasonably well for up to 2 months, though the muthiya's texture softens somewhat — still enjoyable, if not quite as fresh as the day it was made.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the muthiya (dumplings)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Fresh fenugreek leaves (methi), chopped	1 cup	60 g	1 katori
Besan (gram flour)	1 cup	120 g	1 katori
Whole wheat flour	¼ cup	30 g	¼ katori
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Sugar	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Baking soda	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Oil	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste

For the vegetables

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Purple yam (kand), cubed	1 cup	150 g	1 katori
Sweet potato, cubed	1 cup	150 g	1 katori
Small eggplants, quartered	4	200 g	4
Green beans (papdi), cut	1 cup	100 g	1 katori
Fresh tuvar lilva (pigeon peas) or frozen	1 cup	120 g	1 katori

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For the vegetables (cont.)

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Raw banana, cubed	1	120 g	1

For the green masala paste

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Fresh coconut, grated	½ cup	50 g	½ katori
Fresh coriander, chopped	1 cup	40 g	1 katori
Green chili	4	4	4
Garlic cloves	6	6	6
Ginger	1 inch	10 g	1 inch
Sugar	2 tbsp	25 g	2 tbsp
Lemon juice	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach

For the tempering

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Oil	4 tbsp	60 ml	4 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Carom seeds (ajwain)	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Salt	to taste	to taste	to taste

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Purple yam and fresh tuvar lilva can be difficult to find outside India or outside their brief winter season — frozen tuvar lilva is sold at some South Asian grocers, and regular yam or extra sweet potato can substitute for purple yam with a reasonable, if not identical, result. Fresh fenugreek leaves are worth seeking out at South Asian grocers for the muthiya; if unavailable, 2 tablespoons of dried kasuri methi, rehydrated briefly, is a workable substitute.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Muthiya

01 MAKE THE MUTHIYA DOUGH

Combine the chopped fenugreek leaves, besan, whole wheat flour, turmeric, chili powder, sugar, baking soda, oil, and salt. Add a little water if needed to bring together into a firm dough.

02 SHAPE AND STEAM

Shape the dough into small cylindrical logs, about 2 inches long. Steam for 15–18 minutes, until firm and cooked through.



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Making the Muthiya, continued

Chef tip. test doneness by inserting a toothpick — it should come out clean, with no wet batter clinging to it.

03 COOL AND SLICE

Let the steamed muthiya cool slightly, then slice into rounds. Optionally, lightly pan-fry the slices in a little oil for extra texture before adding to the undhiyu.

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The muthiya should be firm and hold their shape when sliced — undercooked muthiya will fall apart later when simmered with the vegetables.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Undhiyu

04 MAKE THE GREEN MASALA PASTE

Blend the coconut, coriander, green chili, garlic, ginger, sugar, and lemon juice to a coarse, fragrant paste.

05 TEMPER AND ADD THE FIRMEST VEGETABLES

Heat oil in a large, heavy-bottomed pot. Add asafoetida and ajwain, letting them sizzle. Add the purple yam and sweet potato first, along with a third of the green masala paste, stirring to coat.



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

Building the Undhiyu, continued

06 LAYER IN THE REMAINING VEGETABLES

Add the eggplant, beans, tuvar lilva, and raw banana, along with the remaining green masala paste and salt. Stir gently to combine without breaking the vegetables apart.

07 COVER AND COOK SLOWLY

Cover tightly and cook on low heat for 35–40 minutes, stirring very gently every 10 minutes, until all the vegetables are tender. Add the sliced muthiya in the last 10 minutes.

Texture indicator. undhiyu should be a rustic mix of tender vegetables in a thick, coating masala — not swimming in liquid, but not dry either.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Stirring too vigorously or too often breaks apart the softer vegetables like eggplant and banana. Stir gently and infrequently, and rely on the covered, low heat to do the work.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served with puri (fried bread) or jalebi, the classic Uttarayan festival pairing — a distinctly Gujarati sweet-savory combination.
- A centerpiece dish at winter family gatherings and festival meals.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Restaurant Presentation

- Served in a bowl showcasing the colorful mix of vegetables, garnished with fresh coriander and grated coconut.

Family Style

- A large shared pot at winter festival gatherings, ladled generously alongside puri or rice.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- Layering vegetables by cooking time and stirring gently, rather than vigorously, preserves each piece's shape and texture.
- A generous amount of the green masala paste, distributed throughout, is essential to undhiyu's deep, complex flavor.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Muthiya can be steamed and sliced a day ahead, refrigerated, and added fresh to the vegetables when cooking.
- The green masala paste can also be made a day in advance and refrigerated.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Specialty undhiyu shops in Surat still use the traditional underground pit method for large batches, believing it produces a smokier, more melded flavor than any stovetop method can fully replicate — a detail worth knowing even if you can't recreate it at home.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

260 kcal	7 g	34 g	11 g	8 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with oil and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Surti Undhiyu	the classic Surat-style version featured here, with the full traditional vegetable mix.
Simplified Undhiyu	a home-cook shortcut version using fewer vegetables when the full traditional mix isn't available.
Green Peas Undhiyu	some households substitute green peas for tuvar lilva when it's out of season.

Can I make undhiyu without purple yam?

Yes — substitute regular yam or additional sweet potato; the flavor will differ slightly but the dish remains delicious.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why is my undhiyu watery?

Likely too much liquid was added, or the pot wasn't covered tightly enough during cooking. Undhiyu should be relatively dry, coated rather than swimming in sauce.

Is undhiyu very spicy?

It has warmth from green chili but leans more toward complex, herbaceous flavor than significant heat — adjust chili quantity to your preference.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Undhu	Gujarati for "upside down," describing the dish's traditional cooking method.
Muthiya	small steamed dumplings made from fenugreek leaves and gram flour, essential to this dish.
Tuvar Lilva	fresh pigeon peas, available only during a brief winter window.
Uttarayan	Gujarat's January kite-flying festival, closely associated with this dish.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Undhiyu

45m	1h
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
6	Hard
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

MUTHIYA (DUMPLINGS)

Fresh fenugreek leaves	60 g
Besan	120 g
Whole wheat flour	30 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	1.5 g
Sugar	4 g
Baking soda	1 g
Oil	30 ml
Salt	3 g

VEGETABLES

Purple yam	150 g
Sweet potato	150 g
Small eggplants	200 g
Green beans	100 g
Fresh tuvar lilva	120 g
Raw banana	120 g

GREEN MASALA PASTE

Fresh coconut	50 g
Fresh coriander	40 g
Green chili	4
Garlic cloves	6
Ginger	10 g
Sugar	25 g
Lemon juice	30 ml

TEMPERING

Oil	60 ml
Asafoetida	pinch
Carom seeds	3 g
Salt	to taste

METHOD

01 **Make the muthiya dough.** Combine the chopped fenugreek leaves, besan, whole wheat flour, turmeric, chili powder, sugar, baking soda, oil, and salt.

02 **Shape and steam.** Shape the dough into small cylindrical logs, about 2 inches long.

03 **Cool and slice.** Let the steamed muthiya cool slightly, then slice into rounds.

04 **Make the green masala paste.** Blend the coconut, coriander, green chili, garlic, ginger, sugar, and lemon juice to a coarse, fragrant paste.

05 **Temper and add the firmest vegetables.** Heat oil in a large, heavy-bottomed pot.

06 **Layer in the remaining vegetables.** Add the eggplant, beans, tuvar lilva, and raw banana, along with the remaining green masala paste and salt.

07 **Cover and cook slowly.** Cover tightly and cook on low heat for 35–40 minutes, stirring very gently every 10 minutes, until all the vegetables are tender.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Fresh fenugreek leaves	60 g	☐ Besan	120 g
☐ Whole wheat flour	30 g	☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g
☐ Red chili powder	1.5 g	☐ Sugar	see recipe
☐ Baking soda	1 g	☐ Oil	see recipe
☐ Salt	see recipe	☐ Purple yam	150 g
☐ Sweet potato	150 g	☐ Small eggplants	200 g
☐ Green beans	100 g	☐ Fresh tuvar lilva	120 g
☐ Raw banana	120 g	☐ Fresh coconut	50 g
☐ Fresh coriander	40 g	☐ Green chili	4
☐ Garlic cloves	6	☐ Ginger	10 g
☐ Lemon juice	30 ml	☐ Asafoetida	pinch
☐ Carom seeds	3 g		

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com